

USER-CENTERED DESIGN OF GAMES FOR GAELIC DIGITAL NORMALISATION

Phases of Ethical Significance

Phase 1: Recruitment, Ethics & Preparation (Weeks 1-4) – School Open Monday 5 th January					
Goal: Secure access, verify safety, and obtain legal consent					
Step	Operation / Action	Party Involved	Documents & Forms	DEC 2025 - JAN 2026	Timeline / Duration
1.0	Ethics & Permission	Researcher Ethics Committee Supervisor	- UTREC Approval (Univ. St Andrews) - Local Authority Approval (Comhairle Nan Eilean Siar) - School Approval		Pre-contact
1.1	Initial Contact	Researcher to School Head	- letter-to-school-in-principle.pdf 		Email sent
1.2	Verification Meeting	Researcher & Head Teacher	- Agenda: Confirm dates, logistics, and eligible classes.		15–30 mins
1.3	Formal Confirmation	School to Researcher	- letter-to-school-commencing.pdf 		Written confirmation
1.4	Teacher Mock Session	Researcher & Class Teachers	- Activity: Demo of game prototype. - Goal: Verify cultural/age appropriateness & safeguarding. - Outcome: Greenlight for pupil sessions.		30 mins
1.5	Consent Distribution	School Admin / Teachers	- PG_PIS pdf (Parent Info Sheet) - PG_Consent-form pdf - letter-to-parentguardian.pdf - T_PIS pdf (Teacher Info Sheet) - T_Consent Form pdf 5 x 		15–20 mins (admin time)
1.6	Consent Collection	Parents & Teachers to School	- Signed Consent Forms (Must be returned to participate). 		1 week window
1.7	Pupil Selection	Class Teacher	- Action: Cross-reference signed forms with eligible pupils (GME, 8-12y).		15–30 mins

Phase 2: Research Session - "The Day Of Experiment" (Spring Week 2026)					
Goal: Data collection with continuous safeguarding					
Step	Operation / Action	Party Involved	Documents & Forms	FEBRUARY 2026	Timeline / Duration
2.1	Room Setup	Researcher	- Laptops/Tablets, Power supply		30 mins pre-session
2.2	Child Assent	Researcher to Pupils	- Child-Participant-Information-Script.pdf - Critical: Verbal script read aloud. Verbal "Yes" required. Children told they can stop anytime. 		5–10 mins
2.3	Activity 1: Gameplay	Pupils (Supervised by Teacher)	- Prototype Game: Interactive Gaelic language game. - Note: Teacher present for safeguarding but does not play.		30–40 mins
2.4	Activity 2: Evaluation	Pupils & Teachers	- Pupil-Qualtrics-Questionnaire - Teaching-Staff-Qualtrics-Questionnaire Format: Digital (Qualtrics) survey 2 x 		5–10 mins
2.5	Activity 3: Discussion	Researcher & Pupils	- Discussion-Group-Guide.pdf - Format: Conversational group feedback (Field notes taken). 		10–15 mins
2.6	Session Close	Researcher	- Distribution of Rewards: 1. Certificate of Participation 2. Small stationery item		Immediate post-session
2.7	Debriefing	Researcher to All	- PG_Debrief_Letter.pdf (Sent home) - T_Debrief-Letter.pdf (Handed to teacher) 2 x 		Handout

Phase 3: Post-Study & Data Governance (Week 5-9)					
Goal: Anonymization and compliance with withdrawal rights					
Step	Operation / Action	Party Involved	Protocol / Rule	MARCH – 3 rd APRIL	Timeline / Deadline
3.1	Pseudonymization	Researcher	- Ensure no names / personal identifiers present, only Participant Codes (e.g., P01, T01). - Securely separate consent forms from data.		Immediately after visit
3.2	Withdrawal Window	Parents / Teachers	- Right to Withdraw: Participants may contact researcher to delete data. - Constraint: Must be done within 48 hours of data collection.		48 Hours post-session
3.3	Final Anonymization	Researcher	- After 48h, the link between Code and Name is deleted. - Data is uploaded to University Cloud. 		> 48 Hours
3.4	Analysis & Reporting	Researcher	- Analysis of gameplay metrics and questionnaire responses. - Writing of thesis/report.		Up to 4 weeks after



Form



Destroy Personal Data



Digital Questionnaire



Signed Form